realizing his determined stance China called off the attack in October. But this incident ruptured the Sino-Soviet bonhomie on the one hand as the Chinese communists realized the unreliability of Soviet support and on the other escalated the tension between the superpowers.

The Middle East became a hot bed of tension in the mid 1950s. The Suez crisis set the stage for another bout of hostility between the superpowers in the Middle East. Following the nationalization of the Anglo-French Suez Canal Company on 26 July 1956, Great Britain, France and Israel decided to initiate a concerted attack against Egypt as their trade and security interests were suddenly jeopardized. Israel especially was vociferous against Egypt because of the understanding between the Soviet Union and Egypt, followed by mass influx of Soviet arms in the region. The Western powers also apprehended a Soviet–Egyptian alliance. The French and the British motive was to overthrow the Arab Nationalist Government of Nasser because his **pan-Arabism** gave much trouble in the respective overseas colonies of French and British in this region and the Suez crisis gave them a pretext to save them from the dissolution of their colonial empire.

President Eisenhower, in the face of a nuclear threat against Britain and France by Moscow and decision to send Soviet volunteers to support Egypt, proclaimed the so-called **Eisenhower Doctrine** in January 1957. In a message to the Congress, he maintained that the US troops would be used to protect the nations in the region from the countries that were “controlled by international communism”. The Eisenhower Doctrine had the same objective in regard to Middle East as Truman Doctrine had towards Greece and Turkey, i.e., **containment of communism**[9], which automatically added to the superpower rivalry.

The Soviet intervention in Hungarian Revolt of 1956 also embittered the relations between the superpowers. Following the decision of the Hungarian Prime Minister, Imre Nagy, to withdraw from the WARSAW Pact and establish the country’s neutrality, on 4 Nov 1956, the Red Army intervened in a bid to prevent Hungary from joining the Western bloc and weakening the Eastern bloc. Secretary of State,